

Week 07 Knowledge Check — TPM Academy

Week 7 Knowledge Check — Agile Delivery & ADO Mastery

A short retention check covering the week's core ideas: outputs vs outcomes and the Agile Manifesto, ADO hierarchy and field discipline, outcome/leading-indicator tracking, Lean value stream mapping, and removing delivery bottlenecks. Answer each question, then check yourself against the key at the end. Aim for concepts, not trivia — every answer maps back to something we used in a lab.

Format: 12 questions (multiple choice + true/false). ~15 minutes. Individual or triad.

Questions

1. (MC) Which of the following is a true *outcome* rather than an output?

- A. "Reconcile flow shipped July 15"
- B. "We delivered all 23 user stories in the sprint"
- C. "Dispatchers spend 30 minutes less per shift"
- D. "The outcome is shipping the feature"

2. (MC) The Agile Manifesto value "working software over comprehensive documentation" most accurately means:

- A. PRDs, TCDs, and TMDs are waste and should be dropped
- B. Documentation is valuable, but subordinate to working software
- C. Teams should stop writing plans
- D. Daily stand-ups replace written docs

3. (T/F) A counter-outcome names a result you *don't* want — a guardrail signaling you may have won the primary outcome for the wrong reasons.

4. (MC) The correct ADO 4-level hierarchy, top to bottom, is:

- A. Feature → Epic → User Story → Task
- B. Epic → Feature → User Story → Task
- C. Epic → User Story → Feature → Task

- D. Epic → Feature → Task → User Story
5. (T/F) A user story estimated at more than 13 story points should be split before it enters a sprint.
6. (MC) Which of the 5 essential queries is called out as high-leverage because it catches forgotten work?
- A. Open in current sprint
 - B. Blocked
 - C. Stale (no movement > N days)
 - D. Done in this sprint
7. (MC) In the output / outcome / leading-indicator “triple,” the *leading indicator* is:
- A. The feature that shipped
 - B. The final business result measured at 30–90 days
 - C. The early signal you can watch before the outcome lands
 - D. The number of stories completed this sprint
8. (T/F) “If a metric has no cadence, it has no audience.”
9. (MC) Flow efficiency is calculated as:
- A. Lead time / process time × 100%
 - B. Process time / lead time × 100%
 - C. WIP / throughput
 - D. Throughput / cycle time
10. (T/F) Lean’s foundational claim is that most of the time work spends in a system is spent being actively worked on, not waiting.
11. (MC) According to the Theory of Constraints (Goldratt), a system’s throughput is limited by:
- A. The sum of all the slow steps
 - B. Exactly one bottleneck at a time
 - C. The team’s average velocity
 - D. The number of code reviewers
12. (MC) What separates a real bottleneck-removal experiment from a wish?
- A. A named owner plus a team-wide announcement
 - B. A hypothesis with a measurable success criterion (baseline → target → window)
 - C. Broad agreement that the change “feels better”
 - D. A longer sprint to give it room
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Answer Key

1. C — “Dispatchers spend 30 min less per shift” is what *changed for the user*. A and B are outputs; D is an output dressed in outcome’s clothes (“the outcome is shipping” is the trap language to catch).

- 2. B** — The Manifesto values documentation *less* than working software, not zero. PRDs/TCDs/TMDs/SEPs are valuable and support working software; “no docs” is the most common rookie misreading.
- 3. True** — Counter-outcomes are the guardrails (inherited from the NS Defense Card). Example: reconcile time drops but support tickets rise > 20% — you won the primary by adding new pain.
- 4. B** — Epic → Feature → User Story → Task. Don’t go deeper than 4 levels, and don’t promote a Task to a User Story just to “make it visible.”
- 5. True** — Stories over 13 points are too vague to estimate. Split them. Story points are a learning/calibration tool even when imperfect.
- 6. C** — The “stale” query (no movement > N days) catches forgotten work — the highest-leverage query for TPMs.
- 7. C** — The leading indicator is the *early* signal (e.g., first-attempt completion $\geq 80\%$ by week 2). Without it you wait 30 days to learn the outcome failed.
- 8. True** — Every metric needs a cadence (daily / sprint / monthly / quarterly) tied to a real audience. No cadence means nobody owns looking at it.
- 9. B** — Flow efficiency = process time / lead time $\times 100\%$. Single-digit percentages are typical. (WIP / throughput is Little’s Law for cycle time — the distractor.)
- 10. False** — The opposite: most time is *waiting*, not being worked on. A story with 2 hours of coding may sit 3 weeks. Reduce the waiting and you save weeks.
- 11. B** — Exactly one bottleneck at a time. Optimizing anything else just piles inventory in front of the constraint. Find it, move it, then find the next one.
- 12. B** — A measurable success criterion (baseline → target → window). “We’ll see if it feels better” is not an experiment; vibes don’t decide.